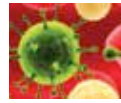




Carbon negative power stations
Iceland Has Built a Carbon Negative Power Station Using Volcanic Rock
<https://digit.in/oct21-65>



Monkey genes to prevent HIV?
Gene found in monkeys, mice could work as antiviral to block HIV, Ebola, other deadly viruses. <https://digit.in/oct21-66>

Why are there no rats in Alberta? 🇨🇦

Afraid of rats? The only way is Alberta.

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he Canadian province of Alberta is the only populated (4 million people) region on the entire

planet that has won humanity's centuries-long battle against the pesky rodent. Shown to the right is the global distribution, the striped area is Alberta, where occasionally rats may cross the border. This is the story of how this one province managed to keep rats at bay.



A RATTY HISTORY

The Norway Rat, a.k.a the Common Rat, Street Rat, Brown Rat etc, is not native to the North American continent and cannot survive in natural areas. They are intrinsically linked to humans and need us to survive. Research and records estimate that rats were first introduced to the eastern coast of North America around 1775 and gradually moved west along with the people who settled the lands.

THE FIRST ENCOUNTER

Extending their range by about 24 kms per year, rats were first reported on the eastern border of Alberta in the summer of 1950, by researchers tracking diseases in squirrels. With the fear of plague and awareness of the potential economic destruction that rats can cause, the Alberta government took it upon itself to halt or at least slow the spread of rats into

their province. The job of rat removal and control was then transferred to the Department of Agriculture as the Minister of Agriculture could authorise and designate any animal that was likely to destroy or harm any crops or livestock as pests thanks to the Agricultural Pests Act of Alberta, 1942. This legislation laid the groundwork for Alberta's long and successful battle against rats.

THE KNEE-JERK REACTION

Despite the legislative mandate, it wasn't smooth sailing. The government of Alberta did not have the expertise to deal with the rapid pace of the rat invasion and most of the residents of Alberta had never seen a rat and therefore did not know what to look out for or how to protect against them on a household level. To that end, in 1950 an amendment to

the Agricultural Pest Act mandated the appointment of a pest control inspector for every municipality and a private pest control firm (Poulin's Pest Control) was contracted to control the insurgence of rats until an effective program could be developed by the Alberta Agriculture authority. An education program was also set up for the public for the quick identification of a rat infestation and effective measures to deploy against them.

The education program for the public had a far-reaching scope with preserved rat specimens being distributed to the Alberta Agricultural offices, conferences on rat control being held in 6 towns of eastern Alberta, 2000 posters being put up and 1500 mimeographed pamphlets being distributed called "Rat Control in Alberta, 1951". The posters, pamphlets and other education programs